J. ROBERT MANUEL

Organist · Choral Director · Composer · Pianist

144 Jarod Drive, Moon Township, PA 15108 · 724-272-1175 · pianomanuel@gmail.com · LinkedIn

Technical Interview Resume — Music — Organist / Choral Director / Composer

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Organist, pianist, choir director, and composer whose primary calling is sacred music: fifteen years as full-time Director of Music Ministries at St. Stephen's Episcopal Church, Sewickley (1994–2009), music posts at Grace Church, Edgeworth, and Christ Church at Grove Farm, and current worship-team service at Impact Christian Church. Master of Music in Choral Conducting (University of Miami); composer of a Gloria for SATB choir and organ and a Magnificat.

MUSIC MINISTRY & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Impact Christian Church — Moon Township, PA **Current**

Worship Team Musician (keyboard and vocals) · Worship-Leader Mentor

- Play and sing on the worship team, bringing organ, piano, and contemporary-worship experience to a modern worship setting.
- Mentor emerging worship leaders in musical preparation, flow, and pastoral sensitivity.

Christ Church at Grove Farm — Sewickley, PA **2016 – Present**

Music Ministry · Worship Leader / Director

- Lead music ministry for a congregation founded in 1995 by members of St. Stephen's, with John Guest as its first rector, on the 46-acre Grove Farm property.
- Plan and lead worship music, blending traditional sacred repertoire with contemporary and crossover styles.

Grace Church — Edgeworth, PA **2014 – 2015**

Director of Music

- Directed the parish music program — choral preparation, service playing, and repertoire for the liturgical year — concurrently with a Lead V&V engineering role.

Geneva College — Beaver Falls, PA **9/2010 – 6/2011**

Adjunct Music Faculty

- Taught freshman and sophomore core curriculum — individual (solo) ear training and music theory — the year-long core for future music teachers.
- Taught organ, including organ student Daniel Favand, on the pipe organ in an approximately 300-seat classroom built like a performance stage.
- Led a standing-room-only keyboard class on nine full-size keyboards in the basement of the college's old Victorian music house.
- Student-centered method: students brought two pieces they wanted to learn, then chose one work from the approved list for a recital jury of three music department chairs and the piano chair. Every student who remained in the course earned an A.

St. Stephen's Episcopal Church — Sewickley, PA **1993 – 2009**

Director of Music Ministries (full-time), 1994 – 2009 · Assistant Organist (part-time), 1993 – 1994

- Ran a large, full-range music program for a large Episcopal parish, managing more than 50 people weekly; the rector made the music post full-time in 1994.
- Directed the choral program and served as principal organist and pianist for the full liturgical year under the Book of Common Prayer (1979).

- Served during the parish's growth era under John Guest; built repertoire combining the organ and choral canon with contemporary and crossover styles.

University of Miami — Coral Gables, FL **1988 – 1990**

Graduate Teaching Assistant (full teaching assistantship)

- Taught choir, private piano, and classroom music theory to freshman and sophomore classes while completing the Master of Music in Choral Conducting.

CORE COMPETENCIES — MUSIC & WORSHIP

Music, Worship & Teaching

- Pipe organ and piano performance; choir direction for adult, men-and-boys, and university choirs; SATB rehearsal technique
- Liturgical music direction in the Episcopal tradition (Book of Common Prayer 1979); contemporary worship-team leadership
- Sacred choral composition and engraving (SATB and organ); arranging and program-building for touring ensembles
- Collegiate teaching: ear training, music theory, organ studio, group keyboard; mentoring of worship leaders and young musicians

MUSIC LEADERSHIP & PERFORMANCE HISTORY

Formation and early training

- Countertenor in the Episcopal men-and-boys choir in Southport, Connecticut, under Ben Hawks.
- Organ study with Mrs. Larson, Dan Hursey, and Thomas Crawford, with study links to David Craighead; chamber Bach with Igor Kipnis in Greenwich, Connecticut, programs.
- Organ study at Northwestern University with Grigg Fountain and my primary organ instructor, Richard Enright.

Performance & tours

- University of Miami Singers world tours to Australia and to Romania, Yugoslavia, and Austria, performing a half-choral / half show-choir program I wrote.
- Music for a three-city series of large outdoor programs with John Guest, held in parking lots and open-air sites.
- Organ endurance repertoire (e.g., Bach in A minor, Finlandia) with refined stop sense and registration.
- Crossover pianist in Billy Joel, Elton John, and James Taylor repertoire for worship and outreach.

COMPOSITIONS & ARRANGEMENTS

- **Gloria (SATB and organ).** My first fully engraved score; Book of Common Prayer (1979) Rite II text; Edition Peters–style engraving in a Newzik Pro workflow; dedicated in memory of Sir Stephen Cleobury.
- **Magnificat.** Written and performed at the University of Miami; in active revision (lyrics and chords → Moises Pro stems → engraved score).
- **Direction.** Building a body of sacred choral work in the lane of composers such as Joseph M. Martin, aiming for work worthy of an honorary doctorate.

EDUCATION

University of Miami — Coral Gables, FL **1996**
Master of Music, Choral Conducting — Full Teaching Assistantship (coursework 1988–1990; thesis and degree 1996)

Northwestern University — Evanston, IL **1984 – 1988**
Bachelor of Music Education — student-teaching placements in three public school districts near Evanston

CERTIFICATIONS

- Illinois K–12 Teaching Certification (Music Education, with Special Education and music therapy) — Northwestern University.

SERVICE

- **YWAM (Youth With A Mission) — Juárez, Mexico.** Taught myself acoustic guitar and led worship bands under pressure for crowds with lines around the corner.
- **Sea Scouts, Ship 84 — Southport, Connecticut.** Member of the Sea Scouts youth maritime program.

MUSIC TECHNOLOGY

Music technology: Logic Pro (48 kHz), MainStage, Spitfire Audio libraries, Newzik Pro, Moises Pro, AU / VST plug-in concepts

REFERENCES

Professional and musical references are available on request.